

2010 ONWARDS

THE NEXT GENERATION

In recent years fashion has moved in new directions to meet the desire of consumers for individualistic looks. No longer satisfied with the big-brand labels, and suffering from "It" bag and logo fatigue, women went on the hunt for fresh looks and original ideas. It was up to a new generation of designers to woo women back to fashion. Alexander Wang, for example, has shown how street cred and savvy design can make millions with a global empire based on grunge meets downtown, while Phoebe Philo's uncompromisingly modern stance at Céline made the once-dowdy label one of the hottest of the early 2010s. Fashion has always thrived on new ideas, and as bored shoppers have gone cold on many mainstream brands, retailers have adapted by commissioning limited-edition collections, such as Eytys x H&M, Halpern x Topshop, and JW Anderson x Converse. Even online retailers have picked up on the trend with exclusive styles from designers. Meanwhile, luxury houses have reinvented themselves with the help of creative talent drawn from the next generation.

VICTORIA BECKHAM

After more than a decade in the industry, Victoria Beckham has shown that the most valuable part of her fashion brand is her own identity – a hard-working mother with a famous husband and four children, all of whom are fashion-show front-row (FROW) regulars. She wears her own clothes, and has evolved with her market. Starting with a small range of jeans and eyewear in 2006, Beckham moved on to the world of high-end ready-to-wear in 2008. Initially sceptical, the fashion press have given rave reviews, and her collections, shown first in New York and now in London, have been a commercial success. Beckham has also mastered Instagram, and astutely uses her lifestyle to strengthen her brand.



Young cosmopolitan
Manhattan-based Taiwanese-Canadian Jason Wu designs luxury sportswear and beautiful evening dresses, like this one from Autumn/Winter 2012 modelled by Cara Delevingne. First Lady Michelle Obama chose four of his dresses in 2008 to wear to public events.



Tasselled details appeared throughout Autumn/Winter 2012 collection

Hot pink, draped satin shows dressmaking mastery

Shoulder reminiscent of Chinese armour

Lace embroidery inspired by Qing Dynasty



All-white looks fresh

Deconstructed tailoring

Shoes are part of brand

Gold slashes evoke duct tape

2010

Cool kid US designer Alexander Wang, who fuses casual elements with laid-back tailoring and sporty separates, is admired for being in tune with the needs of the modern customer. He has successfully built a global brand, while remaining edgy.



Wide, notched waistband with buttoned tab

Meticulously tailored and tapered sleeves

Subtle use of white to shape the torso

Same print also covers shoes

Print master With a talent for abstraction and precise construction, London-based Erdem Moralioglu creates romantic clothes with a contemporary edge. His innovative prints place dense patterns next to empty zones, often with deliberate asymmetry.